

The Department of Defense and its relationship with Legislators

PS 699: Independent Study

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Contents

Data	1
Top 10 Legislators who wrote to DoD and VA combined	1
Limitations	11
References	11

Data

In all, we have 8005 letters received by the DoD marked “congressional” since 2003. All of these are from Members of the U.S. Congress.

```
load(here("data/all_contacts.RData"))
# one obs per member per letter for all agencies
d <- all_contacts %>% filter(str_detect(agency, "DOD"))
```

Top 10 Legislators who wrote to DoD and VA combined

```
# top overall
d %>% count(bioname,party,cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators who wrote")
```

Table 1: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	cqlabel	n
GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest	(R)	(IA)	199
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	(AZ)	125
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	(FL)	89
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	(VA-04)	86
BURR, Richard M.	(R)	(NC)	79
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	(MO)	75

bioname	party	cqlabel	n
RUBIO, Marco	(R)	(FL)	69
HUNTER, Duncan Duane	(R)	(CA-50)	62
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	(PA)	62
WITTMAN, Robert J.	(R)	(VA-01)	61

```
d %>% count(TYPE, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Most Common Policy Areas")
```

Table 2: Most Common Policy Areas

TYPE	n
1	3898
NA	3759
5	149
6	88
0	47
2	36
3	25
4	3

```
##Types of Policy each member dealt with
```

```
d %>% count(bioname, party, TYPE, cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators w
```

Table 3: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	TYPE	cqlabel	n
GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest	(R)	NA	(IA)	179
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	NA	(AZ)	64
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	NA	(VA-04)	58
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	NA	(MO)	57
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	1	(FL)	54
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	1	(AR)	49
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	1	(AZ)	49
WEBB, James H. (Jim)	(D)	NA	(VA)	45
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	6	(CA-08)	43
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	1	(PA)	40

###Senators and Veteran Population ###Still Working On this!!!!

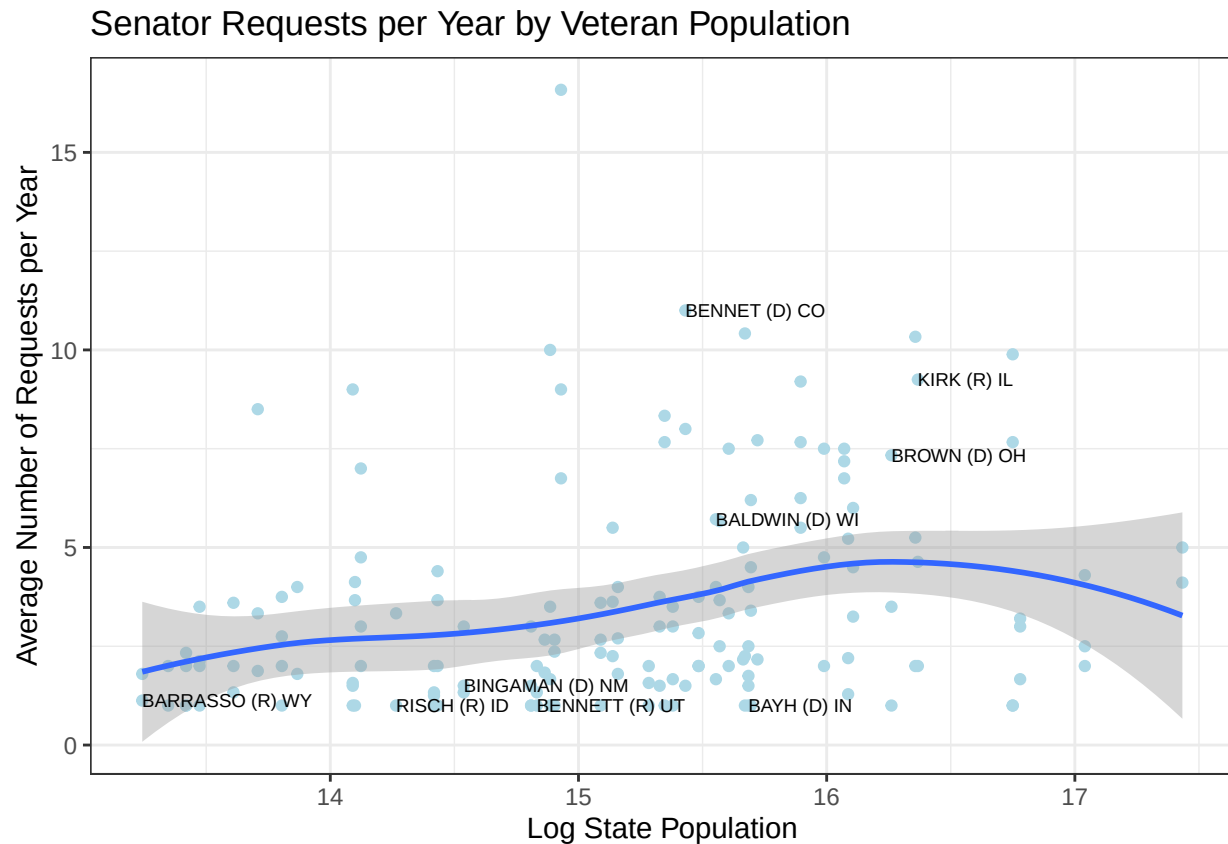
```
d %>%
  filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
                y = mean,
```

```

    label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
                    member_state, ""),
    check_overlap = TRUE,
    size = 2.5,
    hjust = 0) +
theme_bw() +
labs(title = "Senator Requests per Year by Veteran Population",
     x = "Log State Population",
     y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")

```

`geom\_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'



Senators vs. state population

```

d %>%
  filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
                y = mean,

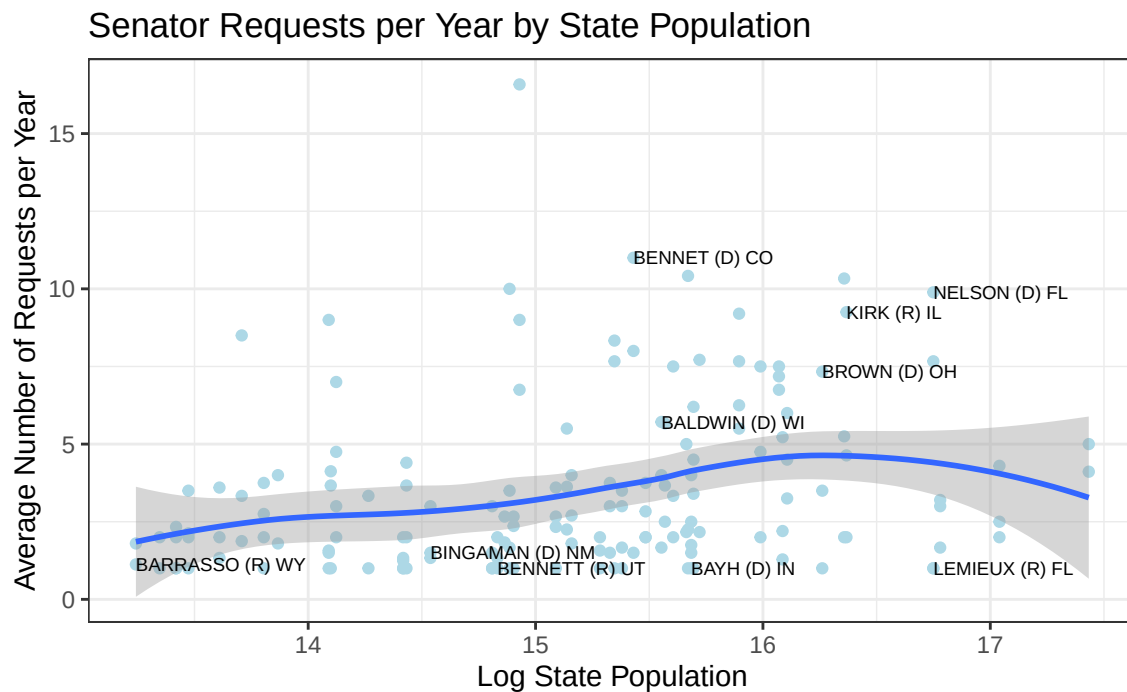
```

```

    label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
                    member_state, ""),
    check_overlap = TRUE,
    size = 2.5,
    hjust = 0) +
theme_bw() +
labs(title = "Senator Requests per Year by State Population",
     x = "Log State Population",
     y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")

```

```
## `geom_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'
```



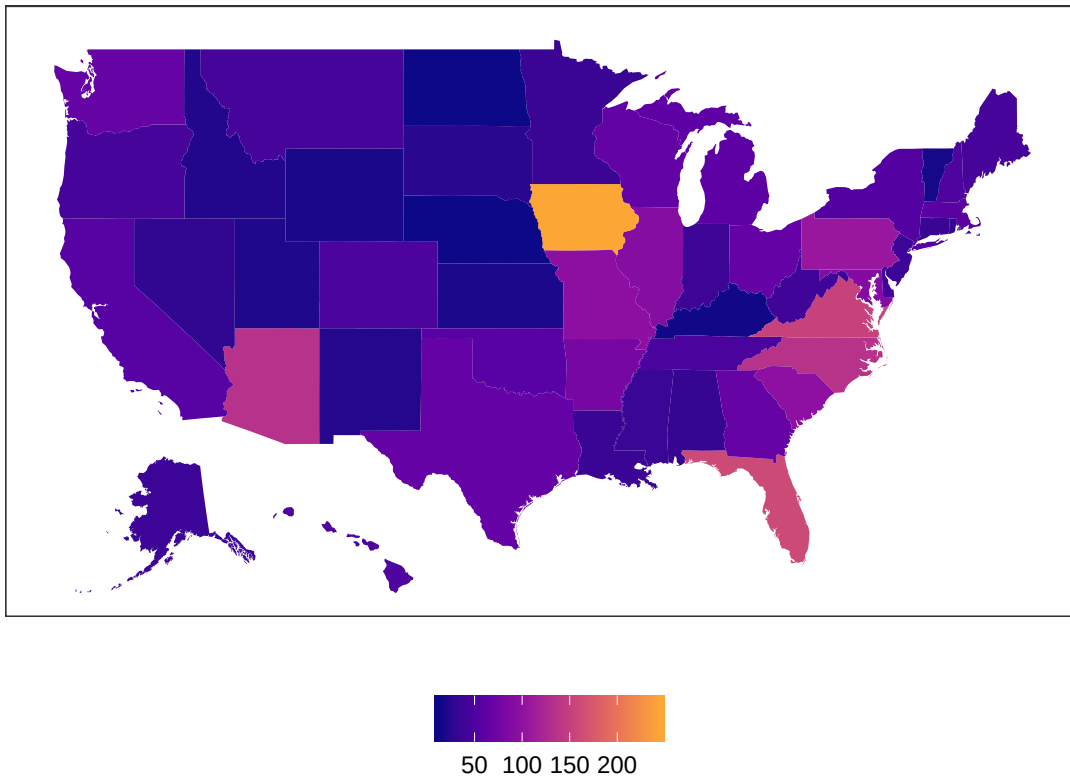
```

Chamber = "Senate"

d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
ggplot() +
  # map points to the fifty_states shape data
  geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
  expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
  coord_map() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
  scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
        panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)

```

Total Number of Contacts from members of the Senate



```
# d %>%
#   ungroup() %>%
#   filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
#   group_by(state, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
#   mutate(Per_Capita = n/pop2010*1000000) %>%
#   # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column in your data
#   ggplot() +
#   # map points to the fifty_states shape data
#   geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = Per_Capita), map = fifty_states) +
#   expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
#   coord_map() +
#   scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Contacts Per hundred thousand Residents from Members of the", C
#   scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
#   theme(legend.position = "bottom",
#         legend.title = element_blank() )#+facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)

# d %>%
#   mutate(Per_Capita = n/pop2010*1000000) %>% ##FIXME non-numeric argument to binary operator
#   # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column in your data
#   ggplot() +
#   # map points to the fifty_states shape data
#   geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = Per_Capita), map = fifty_states) +
```

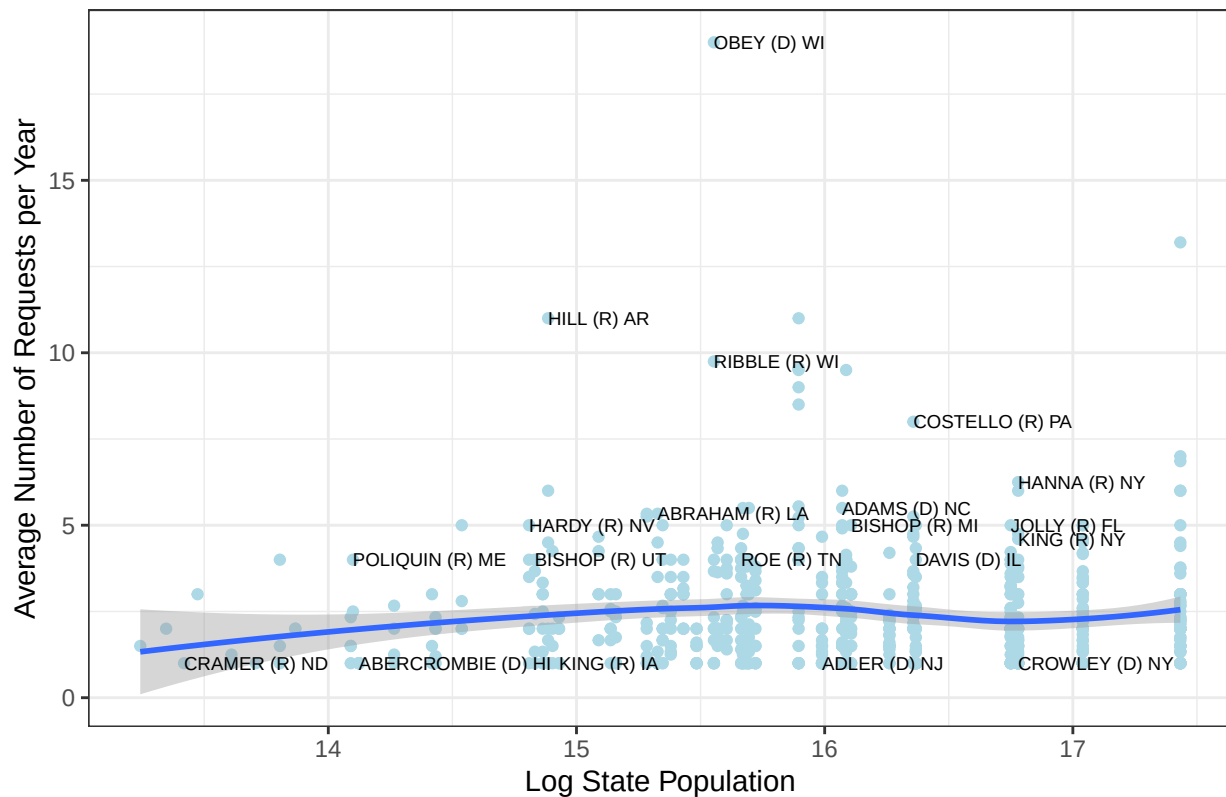
```
# expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
# coord_map() +
# scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
# scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
# labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Contacts Per hundred thousand Residents from Members of the", C
# scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
# theme(legend.position = "bottom",
#       legend.title = element_blank() )+
# facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

##House Contacts per State

```
d %>%
  filter(chamber == "House") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
                y = mean,
                label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
                              member_state, "")),
            check_overlap = TRUE,
            size = 2.5,
            hjust = 0) +
  theme_bw() +
  labs(title = "House Requests per Year by State Population",
       x = "Log State Population",
       y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")
```

`geom\_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'

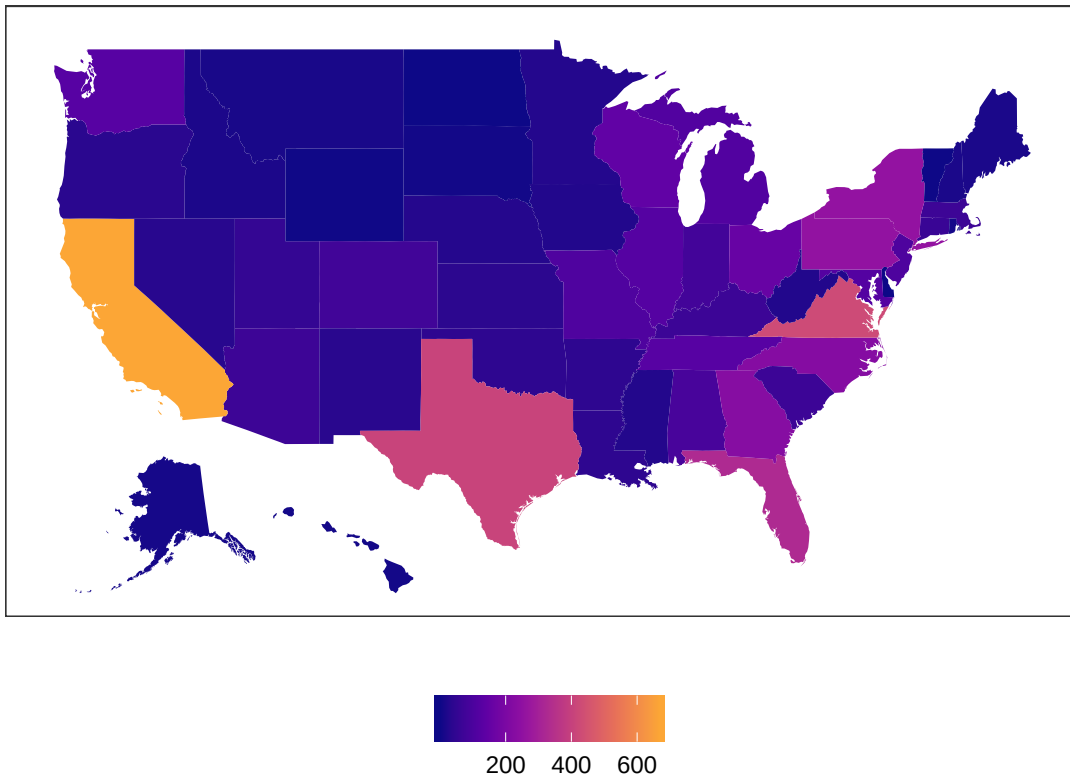
House Requests per Year by State Population



```
Chamber = "House"
```

```
d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
  ggplot() +
  # map points to the fifty_states shape data
  geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
  expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
  coord_map() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
  scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
        panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

Total Number of Contacts from members of the House

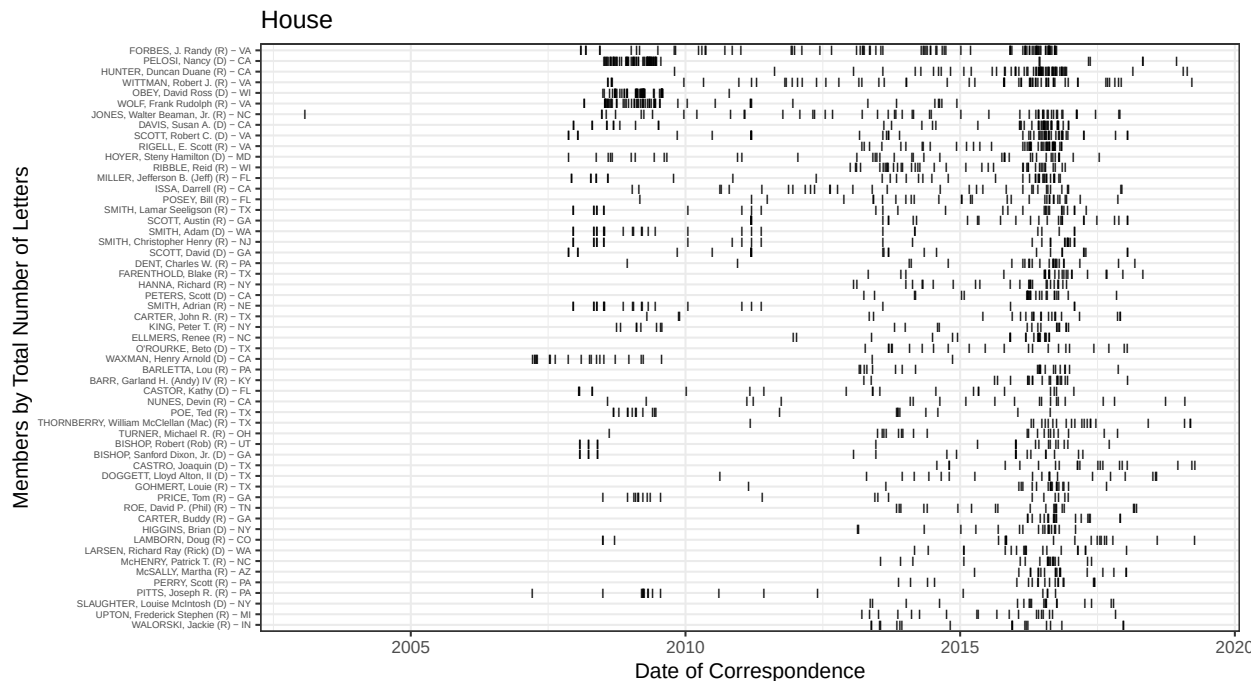


Members who contact DOD and VA more than average:

```
# barcode plot of committee members

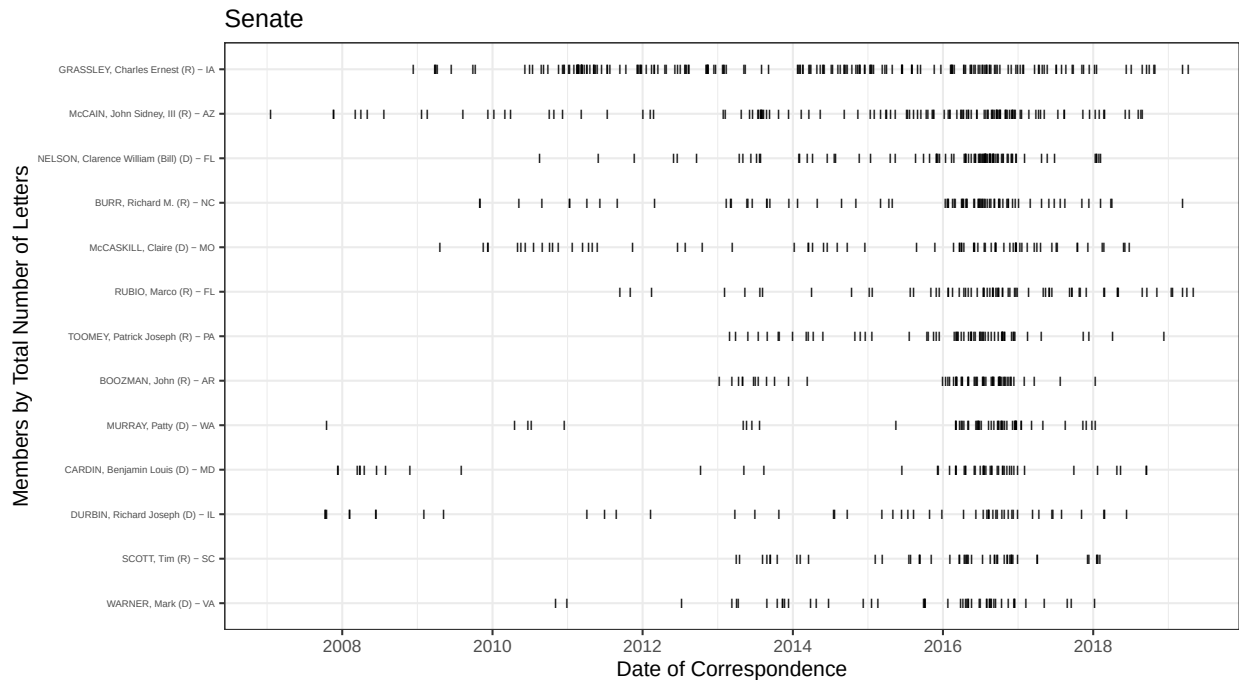
# member by year by agency
d %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
  filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(
    aes(x = DATE,
        y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
    # alpha = .6,
    shape = 73,
    size=2
  ) +
  labs(title = paste(Chamber),
       y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
       x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
  theme(
    legend.title = element_blank(),
```

```
axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
) +
guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```



```
Chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate"

# member by year by agency
d %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
  filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(
    aes(x = DATE,
        y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
    # alpha = .6,
    shape = 73,
    size=2
  ) +
  labs(title = paste(Chamber),
       y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
       x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
  theme(
    legend.title = element_blank(),
    axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
  ) +
  guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```



```
# Chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate"
#
# # member by year by agency
# d %>%
#   filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
#   group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
#   filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
#   ggplot() +
#   geom_point(
#     aes(x = DATE,
#         y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
#     # alpha = .6,
#     shape = 73,
#     size=2
#   ) +
#   labs(title = paste(Chamber),
#        y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
#        x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
#   theme(
#     legend.title = element_blank(),
#     axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
#   ) +
#   guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```

####Fix this, right now visualization is very messy #### Members who contact DOD more, relative to other agencies:

```
# chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate" ##still is bringing in House members
#
# all_contacts %>%
#   mutate(DOD = agency == "DOD$") %>%
```

```
# group_by(chamber, DOD, name_state, state) %>%
# summarise(n = n() ) %>%
# ungroup() %>%
# spread(key = "DOD", value = n) %>%
# #mutate(ShareToDOD = round(`TRUE`/(`TRUE`+`FALSE`),2) ) %>%
# #arrange(-ShareToDOD) %>%
# # mutate(total = `TRUE` + `FALSE`) %>%
# # select(name_state, chamber, total, ShareToDOD) %>%
# # filter(ShareToDOD>.3) %>%
# knitr::kable()
```

Limitations

Throughout the course of this independent study, there were a few challenges and limitations I faced.

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Mia Costa Paper

FERC Paper